

BASIC SIGHT-SINGING AND EAR TRAINING FOR CHURCH SINGERS

UNIT 4.1

RHYTHM

TIED NOTES AND DOTTED NOTES

(HALF-NOTE PULSE)



TIES AND DOTTED NOTES IN CUT TIME

As noted earlier, many Orthodox church hymns are sung using the half note as the pulse. As in the case of music notated for quarter-note pulse, music notated with the half-note pulse (cut time) makes use of ties and dotted note values, as the examples below illustrate.

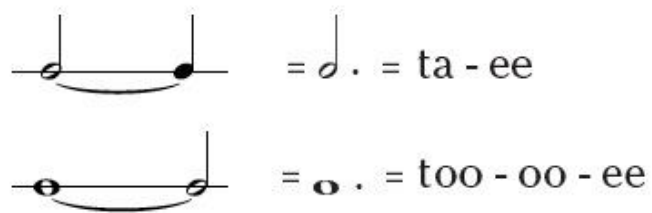
In using the Kodály rhythmic syllables with half-note pulse, we make the adjustment mentioned in Unit 2.1 (Slide 13), whereby the basic half-note pulse is pronounced **ta**, with the syllables for the shorter and longer note values adjusted accordingly.

The diagram illustrates rhythmic notation and syllables in cut time. It is divided into two columns. The left column shows musical notation on a single line with a common time signature 'C'. The first example shows a half note (beamed eighth notes) and a dotted half note (quarter note followed by a dotted quarter note), both labeled '1 2' and '= 1 1/2 beats'. The second example shows a dotted half note and a whole note (beamed eighth notes), both labeled '1 2 3' and '= 3 beats'. The third example shows a whole note and a dotted whole note (half note followed by a dotted half note), both labeled '1 2 3 4' and '= 4 beats'. The right column shows the corresponding Kodály rhythmic syllables: 'ta' for a half note, 'ee' for a dotted half note, 'too-oo' for a whole note, and 'ee-oo' for a dotted whole note. The syllables are written below the notes, with 'ta' and 'ee' for the first two examples, 'too-oo' and 'ee' for the third, and 'too-oo' and 'ee-oo' for the fourth.

(cont'd)

DOTTED NOTES IN CUT TIME

Just as in music notated using quarter-note pulse, when a note value is tied to half of itself, e.g.,  it can be written in shorthand form as a dotted note:



As in the preceding unit, it is helpful to go observe a progression from notes that are **not tied**, to those that **are tied**, to **dotted notes**, with the half note getting the beat.

The image displays four musical exercises, labeled 1a through 1d, on a single staff in C major. Each exercise consists of a sequence of notes with rhythmic syllables written below them. Above each note is a number (1 or 2) indicating a finger or foot count. The exercises show a progression from untied notes to tied notes and finally to dotted notes, with a half note receiving one beat.

1a
Notes: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), C4 (half).
Syllables: ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc.
Finger counts: 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2.

1b
Notes: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), C4 (half).
Syllables: ta, ti, ti, ta, ti, ti, etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc.
Finger counts: 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2.

1c
Notes: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), C4 (half).
Syllables: ta - ee, ti, ta - ee, ti, etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc.
Finger counts: 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2.

1d
Notes: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), C4 (half).
Syllables: ta - ee, ti, ta - ee, ti, etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc., etc.
Finger counts: 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2, 1, 2.

(Note that, using rhythmic syllables, examples 1c and 1d are pronounced identically: ta - ee-ti | ta - ee-ti | ta, etc.)

Here is a similar progression from untied notes to tied notes using larger note values.

2a

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta, etc.

2b

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

too-oo ta ta too-oo ta ta, etc.

2c

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

too-oo-ee ta too-oo-ee ta, etc.

2d

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

too-oo-ee ta too-oo-ee ta, etc.

Detailed description: The image displays four musical examples, labeled 2a through 2d, each on a single staff in 4/2 time. Each example consists of a sequence of notes with corresponding syllables written below. Example 2a uses quarter notes and is labeled 'ta ta ta ta ta ta ta ta, etc.'. Example 2b uses half notes and is labeled 'too-oo ta ta too-oo ta ta, etc.'. Example 2c uses half notes with ties between the first and second notes of each group of four, and is labeled 'too-oo-ee ta too-oo-ee ta, etc.'. Example 2d uses half notes with dots (half notes) and is labeled 'too-oo-ee ta too-oo-ee ta, etc.'. Each example is divided into four groups of four notes, with a double bar line at the end of the fourth group. Above each group of four notes are the numbers 1, 2, 3, and 4, indicating a four-beat measure.

ON THE SPOT PRACTICE!

Practice speaking Examples 1a thru 1d and 2a thru 2d, while keeping a steady pulse. Start slowly, then try a faster tempo.

YOU ARE NOW READY TO PRACTICE
SOME MORE RHYTHMS USING CUT TIME!

Please proceed to RHYTHM EXERCISES 4.1

